FT FollowThrough

The Pressure Washing Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- What needs cleaning: the house, the driveway, a deck, a patio or a fence?
- What's the siding: vinyl, brick, stucco or painted wood? One story or two?
- Any oil or rust stains, or green growth on the shady side?
- Is there an outdoor water tap I can use?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what needs cleaning and I'll see how we can help."

> "Can you text me photos and the address? I can quote today and come Tuesday or Friday. Which works better?"

2. Presenting the quote

- Price flat surfaces by the square foot and house washes by the size of the home, with a minimum per job.
- Say how you'll clean each surface: soft wash for siding, a surface cleaner for concrete.
- Write down what won't come out, like old oil stains or rust, before you start.
- Offer add-ons that cost little extra once you're there: walkways, steps, trash bins.

> "Here's what I'll clean, how I'll clean it and the price. I'll rinse your plants before and after. I can do it on [day]. What questions do you have?"

3. The 7 objections pressure washers hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "Another company quoted less."
"That's fair, compare away. Are they soft washing your siding or blasting it with high pressure? Ask about insurance and whether they rinse your plants. I'll send before and after photos of a house like yours so you can see the result."

2. "I need to run it by the property manager."
"Of course. Who should I send it to? I'll send a one-page summary with the scope, my certificate of insurance and how I handle wash water, so they can approve it quickly."

3. "Can you do it cheaper?"
"Let's see. Could we do the driveway and patio now and the house later? Booking with a neighbor on the same day also lowers the price. I won't skip rinsing your plants or blocking drains, because that's what protects your property."

4. "I'll just rent a pressure washer."
"Plenty of people do. Have you used one on siding or a wood deck? High pressure can strip paint, splinter wood and push water behind siding. Many customers do the patio themselves and hire us for the house. I can quote just that."

5. "It can wait until next year."
"That can work. Is there green or black growth on the shady side? Algae and mold keep spreading, make walkways slippery and get harder to remove the longer they sit. I can do the worst areas now and book you early for spring."

6. “Will it damage my house or kill my plants?”
“Fair question, it happens with careless cleaners. Do you have delicate plants or older paint? I use low pressure on siding, rinse your plants before and after, and do a test spot first. I’m insured for damage, and here’s my certificate.”

7. “Why do I have to pay the minimum for a small job?”
“Fair question. What else needs cleaning while I’m there? Every job takes setup, travel and cleanup whatever the size, so the minimum covers that. Adding a walkway, steps or trash bins usually costs little extra and makes the visit worth it.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the quote come through okay? Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], I’m working on your street on [day]. If you’d like to go ahead, I can do yours the same day.”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If you’d like just the driveway for now, reply and I’ll fit you in.”

Homeowners often book within days of seeing a neighbor’s clean driveway. When you finish a job, quote the houses on either side.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask right after the job, when the clean surface is still wet and shining, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with how it looks, would you leave a quick Google review with a before-and-after photo? I’ll text you the link. And if a neighbor wants theirs done, I’d be glad to help.”

Offer a yearly reminder. Algae comes back, and a customer who books every spring is worth far more than one wash.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Keep wash water out of storm drains, especially on commercial jobs. One complaint can bring a big fine.
- Confirm your liability insurance covers damage to the property you clean: etched concrete, stripped paint, dead plants.
- Walk around before you start, and write down stains, loose boards and plants near the house.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for pressure washers: followthroughguides.com/pressure-washing · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com